Disciplinary & Corrective Action Procedure (HR)

HR's case-management standard for conduct breaches: enquiries, honesty of ev
progressive discipline ladder, documentation and appeals.

REF	KB-HR-03
VERSION	V2.0
EFFECTIVE	01 NOV 2025
FOR	HR TEAM ONLY
CLASSIFICATION	CONFIDENTIAL / HR INTERNAL

This procedure defines how HR handles alleged misconduct with fairness to the complainant, the respondent and the company. It applies to code-of-conduct breaches; allegations of sexual harassment follow the POSH IC procedure exclusively, and grievance-related friction stays on its own track.

1. Principles

- No decision on allegations without the respondent's side heard.
- Evidence is evaluated on documents and records, not rumour; every file must survive review by someone with an opposite view.
- Proportionality: corrective intent first, deterrence of recurrence, punishment only where warranted or statutorily required.
- Confidentiality for everyone involved, on a need-to-know basis.

2. Case flow

Stage	What happens	Target time
Intake	Details recorded; interim risk assessed	1 working day
Preliminary check	Fact verification without the respondent	3–5 working days
Decision to proceed / mediation / drop	Recorded rationale either way	1 working day after check
Show-cause / enquiry	Written charge sheet, reply window, hearing where warranted	5–15 working days
Outcome & action	HR records decision, informs parties, tracks rehabilitation	As warranted

3. The action ladder

- Stage 1 — counselling conversation with documented follow-up date.
- Stage 2 — written warning with specific conduct described and expectations stated.
- Stage 3 — final written warning, possible suspension (up to 4 days India statutory norms / case review).
- Stage 4 — termination following due process, signed off by business head, HR head + legal review (where invoked).

4. Evidence discipline

Retain screen-shots, device logs, access records and communication extracts with chain-of-custody notes (who collected, when, from where). Where devices are company-issued, collection is via IT. Media shared by the complainant is preserved as received — no cropping.

5. Documentation standard

Every case file: intake note, preliminary check record, charge sheet, respondent's reply, supporting evidence, decision rationale, action letter, follow-up dates. The bar is simple — an outside reader must reconstruct what happened without anybody's memory.

> Careful with language: describe behaviour ('used abusive language' with the quote), not personality ('tends to be arrogant'). Files outlive the people in them.